Hate the Loser Inside

By John Kern

(Pg 79-94) *Coach Brodhaus is at a table with a breakfast plate of eggs, bacon, and pancakes; half a grapefruit, a glass of milk, a box and bowl of cereal, silverware, and a napkin.*

COACH BRODHAUS: I'm Coach Donny Brodhaus, Winner of this year's college football national championship. And when I sit down for a championship breakfast, I make sure ***MY*** kitchen *[gestures behind him]* has cabinet fronts and counter tops by Winston's Kitchens and Design. Take it from a winner like me, when it comes to home furnishings, Winston's is the real champion. They've been providing high-quality kitchen interiors since 1970. And with their low, low prices, you won't need to make millions to look like you do. *[awkward pause]* So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the style and class of a Winston's home. Winston's Kitchens and Design: It's what completes a real, really complete, real breakfast. *[blank]*

WENDELL: *[offstage]* Cut!

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 2: *A coach's words can often inspire resilience, teamwork, and the pursuit of excellence.*
ACTOR 1: *Coaches encourage people to push their limits and believe in their potential, regardless of the outcome.*
ACTOR 2: *But that coaching fame only lasts for so long. What do you do when your coaching days are over?*
ACTOR 1: *Low-budget commercials for local companies!*
ACTOR 2: *This Duo sponsored by Winston's Kitchens and Designs . . .*
TOGETHER: *Hate the Loser Inside by John Kern*

WENDELL: *[enters, script in hand]* That was good. That was really good.

COACH B: I keep *messing* up that last line.

WENDELL: It's a tongue twister. It's ... *[slight pause]* Are you ready?

COACH B: Yeah, yeah, just give it to me.

WENDELL: It's . . . "It's what really makes a breakfast complete."

COACH B: It's what really makes a breakfast complete. . . really makes a breakfast complete.

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WENDELL: Good. Good. Coach, we're really proud to have you for this commercial. You're the man who brought the title back to Illinois.

COACH B: It's what really makes a breakfast complete.

WENDELL: Okay. *[slight pause]* So let's just jump back on. *[exits; offstage]* Okay; and rolling.

COACH B: So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the style and class of a Winston's home. Winston's Kitchens and Design: It makes a breakfast what is real. Son of a ****!

WENDELL: *[offstage]* Cut! *[enters]* Maybe . . .

COACH B: Is there an yway I can just skip that line?

WENDELL: I'm sorry. That's been the slogan for Winston's Kitchens and Design for more than twenty years. Maybe we should start in the middle and work your way to the line.

COACH B: Sure, I'll give that a shot. You know what might also help . . . If we could get a real kitchen.

WENDELL: I already explained, the kitchen will be put in post-production. That way, throughout the commercial, we can change the Winton's design in the background. *[Coach reaches into the box of cereal and starts eating a dry handful]* What we need from you is to just look at the camera, And . . . And don't shift anything on the table. Everything on the table is placed carefully, so the camera picks it up but it doesn't block your face. *[adjusts the cereal box back in place]*

COACH B: I get that. I just think it'd be a little easier to focus on talking about a kitchen, if there was an actual kitchen. But I don't want to hold this up, so . . . Can I see the script?

WENDELL: *[hands the script to Coach B]* So let's take it from, "They've been providing high quality kitchen interiors since 1970."

COACH B: Could we start with something shorter?

WENDELL: I'm confident you can get it. And I want you to add

COACH B: *[interrupting]* You want me to ***add*** something?

WENDELL: After the line, "You won't need to make millions to look like you do." add a wink to the camera. Can you wink?

COACH B: Like this? *[can't help but use two eyes]*

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WENDELL: No, more like . . . *[Coach B winks]* Just one eye. Like . . . *[Coach B winks]* Try to keep the other *[Coach B winks]* the other eye open. *[Coach B winks]* *[Wendell tries to hold Coach Brodhaus 's eye open]* Now try. *[Coach B winks; both eyes close]* Don't fight it. Don't fight ... Open the other eye! *[Coach B winks]* Just forget the wink. Can you instead . . . Cross your arms and smile? *[demonstrates]* Cross you arms *[crosses arms]* then smile. *[smiles]*

COACH B: Like this? *[crosses arms and smiles]*

WENDELL: Perfect. After the line . . .

COACH B: "You won't need to make millions to look like you do."

WENDELL: Perfect. And . . . and take it from, "Take it from a winner like me."

COACH B: Uh . . . *[looking at the script]*

WENDELL: Ooo, can't have that in the shot. *[snatches script and exits]* *[offstage]* Places. Ready, Coach?

COACH B: I'm ready.

WENDELL: *[offstage]* And rolling. *[Coach B look to camera. Clears his throat.]* *[offstage]* ***Still*** rolling.

COACH B: Take it from a winner like me, when it comes to home furnishings, Winston's is the real champion. They've been providing high-quality kitchen interiors since 1970. And with their low, low prices, you won't need to make millions you look like you do. *[stiffly crosses arms, no smile; sudden very fake smile]* So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the steel and clips of **** *[creatively curses]*

WENDELL: *[offstage]* That was good. Take it from, "And with their low, low prices."

COACH B: And with their low, low prices, you won't need to make millions to look like you do. *[bright smile; then no smile, stiffly crosses arms]* I just did that backwards, right?

WENDELL: *[offstage]* Not a problem. Take it again. Still rolling.

COACH B: And with their low, low prices, you won't need to make millions to look like you do. *[crosses arms; smiles]* So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the style and clams of a Winston's fern. ***** *[creatively curses]*

WENDELL: *[offstage]* Cut! *[enters]* Coach, you're doing good. Really.

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COACH B: I don't get it. My whole brain has been . . . *[blows raspberry]* I won a national football championship, and now I can't do some cheap, local commercial.

WENDELL: We're still doing good.

COACH B: It's the damn arm crossing. Before I just had problems with the last line. Now I can't do any of it. *[grabs a chair and rattles it against the floor]*

WENDELL: Do you need a moment?

COACH B: I'm good. I just want to get this done. It's my head that's a sack of farts. *[taps fists on table; restrained anger]* You know what I told my players before the Tostitos Fiesta Bowl, *[dramatic pause]* I told them, "Give me 100% and you will forever be the greatest there ever was." *[pause]* Those kids were gladiators that night, motorized by a passion I inspired. And now I can't *say* the word kitchen without my brain burning.

WENDELL: Yeah, it can be hard . . . Keeping your mind on track, just so you can get through the day. I wanted to go to Hollywood, when I was in my twenties. But then . . . You fall in love with a girl who wants to settle down, and so you settle for whatever. Then that girl divorces you. And you realize yours is an all too common tale. You look around and all you notice is marinara crusting on dishes and a whole lot of *stuff* that needs to be Swiffered. And you start to think of the kid you were . . . the dumbest *kid*. . . who ever walked this earth. As if what you were -- what you still are -- Is unforgivable.

COACH B: What's your name again?

WENDELL: Um ... Wendell. It's Wendell.

COACH B: Well, Wendell, when I hear your story, you know what I hear? I hear the whining whimper of a quitter. I hear a man who didn't fight for what he wanted.

WENDELL: *[to the crew]* Can we get ready? We're going to roll in a second.

COACH B: You're going to hear no a lot in life, sure. But you can't ever say no to yourself. In every one of us, there lives a loser and winner. If you want the winner to succeed, you've got to hate the loser inside. That's how you become a champion, Wendell.

WENDELL: We have to continue on. We're going to start from the very top, okay? *[exits]*

COACH B: *[to self]* C'mon, Donny. You're not a failure! You can whup this commercial!

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WENDELL: *[offstage]* Are you ready, Coach?

COACH B: *[to self]* Crush it, Donny boy, Crush it. *[to Wendell]* Yeah, I'm good. *[to camera]* I'm Coach Donny Brodhaus, Winner of this year's college football national championship. And when I sit down for a chumpionshap brakfust . . . *[sigh] [creatively curses]*

WENDELL: Let's keep going.

COACH B: *[to camera]* I'm Coach Donny Brodhaus, ewnner of this year's college football national championship. And when I sit down for a championship breakfast, I make sure ***MY*** kitchen *[gestures behind him]* has cabinet fronts and counter tops by Winston's Kitchens and Design. Take it from a whimper like pluh / We're not going back. *[creatively curses]*I'm going to keep marching forward.

WENDELL: *[offstage]* Still rolling!

COACH B: *[to self]* You're a champion. You're a champion with a poophead, but you're still a champion. *[to camera]* Take it from a winner like me, when it comes to home furnishings, it would help to remember your line. Take it from a winner like me, when it comes to home furnishings, Winston's is the crapalapa dong ding. *[hurls an apple against the wall]*

WENDELL: *[offstage]* We don't need the apple – not important to the shoot. We're rooting for you, Coach. I know you can finish this!

COACH B: Don't cut. *[shakes his body clearing himself of negativity vibes]*

WENDELL: *[offstage]* C'mon, Coach, Woo! You can nail this copy.

COACH B: Don't patronize me. *[to camera]* Take it from a winner like me, when it comes to home furnishings, Winston's is the real champion. They've been providing high-quality kitchen interiors since 1970. And with their low, low prices, you won't need to make millions to look like you do. *[crosses arms; smiles]* So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the style and class of a Winston's home. Winston's Kitchens and Design: It breakfasts completely. AAGH! *[deep cleansing breath; cracks neck] [to camera]* So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the style and class of a Winston's home. Winston's Kitchens and Design . . . It's a breakfast. Actually, it's a kitchen. *[Coach B starts flipping plates on the table, slamming food against the floor or walls]* I AM SICK OF THIS. *[goes berserk, flips the table. As extreme as*

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possible] [Wendell enters; Coach B brandishes a chair at Wendel] No. NO! Stay back! *[Wendell scurries off][Coach B to camera, calmly and professionally]* I'm Coach Donny Brodhaus, winner of this year's college football national championship. And when I sit down for a championship breakfast, I make sure ***MY*** kitchen *[gestures behind him]* has cabinet fronts and counter tops by Winston's Kitchens and Design. Take it from a winner like me, when it comes to home furnishings, Winston's is the real champion. They've been providing high-quality kitchen interiors since 1970. And with their low, low prices, you won't need to make millions to look like you do. *[crosses arms; smiles: NAILS IT!]* So score a touchdown with your neighbors with the style and class of a Winston's home. Winston's Kitchens and Design: It's what really makes a breakfast complete. *[winks with both eyes]*

WENDELL: CUT!

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AWARD HISTORY

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